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EBRU KASIKARALAR

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EMPLOYMENT

Amazon.com, Inc. Seattle, WA
Research Scientist II *May 2025 – Present*
Amazon Customer Service, Network Planning Intelligence
Planning for the world's largest multi-channel customer service network across phone, chat, email, and self-service channels.
Best Innovator & Change Agent Award, Amazon Customer Service, Q3 2025

EDUCATION

The University of Chicago Booth School of Business Chicago, IL
Ph.D. & MBA in Management Science & Operations Management *2019 – 2025*
Minor in Economics
Dissertation: Dynamic Scheduling of Multiclass Queueing Systems in the Halfin–Whitt Regime: A Computational Approach for High-Dimensional Problems

University of California, Berkeley Berkeley, CA
B.S. in Industrial Engineering and Operations Research (Honors) *2015 – 2019*
Certificate in Technology Entrepreneurship

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Service Operations, Deep Learning, Simulation

TEACHING INTERESTS

Operations Management, Managerial Decision Modeling

PUBLICATIONS AND PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

- **Dynamic Scheduling of a Multiclass Queue in the Halfin–Whitt Regime: A Computational Approach for High-Dimensional Problems.**
  Baris Ata, Ebru Kasikaralar
  Management Science 72(7) (2026): 6309–6333. [arXiv]

- **Dynamic Scheduling of a Parallel-Server Queueing System: A Computational Method for High-Dimensional Problems.**
  Baris Ata, Ebru Kasikaralar
  Major Revision at *Manufacturing & Service Operations Management (MSOM)*.

- **Dynamic Skill-Based Routing for Call Centers with Transfers: A Value-Based Framework.**
  Baris Ata, Ebru Kasikaralar
  Under review.

- **Exploring Cost and Environmental Implications of Optimal Technology Management Strategies in the Street Lighting Industry.**
  Rachel Dzombak, Ebru Kasikaralar, and Heather E. Dillon
  Resources, Conservation & Recycling: X 6 (2020): 100022.

TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

- A Discrete-Time Batch Simulation Framework for Rapid Scenario Planning in Large-Scale Contact Centers
  - 2026 Amazon Machine Learning Conference Workshop on Capacity Planning: Optimization, Simulation and Agentic AI, Seattle, WA.
  - 2026 Amazon Fulfillment Simulation Symposium, Seattle, WA.
- Dynamic Scheduling of a Parallel-Server Queueing System: A Computational Method for High-Dimensional Problems
  - 2026 INFORMS Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA.
  - 2025 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA.
  - 2025 Amazon OptimiST Learning Session, Seattle, WA.
- Dynamic Scheduling of a Multiclass Queue in the Halfin–Whitt Regime: A Computational Approach for High-Dimensional Problems
  - 2025 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA.
  - 2025 Amazon OptimiST Learning Session, Seattle, WA.
  - 2024 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Seattle, WA.
  - 2024 Stochastic Networks Conference, Stockholm, Sweden.
  - 2024 Stanford MS&E Rising Stars Workshop, Stanford, CA.
  - 2023 Chicago Booth Operations Day, Chicago, IL.
  - 2023 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Phoenix, AZ.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

The University of Chicago Booth School of Business, Teaching Assistant

Operations Management (Executive MBA) *Winter 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025*
London, Hong Kong, Chicago

Managerial Decision Modeling (Executive MBA) *Summer 2021*
Chicago

Managerial Decision Modeling (Undergraduate) *Spring 2021, 2022*

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Best Innovator & Change Agent Award, Amazon Customer Service *2025*
- Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Booth School of Business *2025*
  Best TA nominated by Executive MBA cohort in Chicago
- J. Michael Harrison Doctoral Prize, Booth School of Business *2024*
  Doctoral student enrolled at Chicago Booth whose research is judged to make the most impactful contribution to theory
- Katherine Dusak Miller PhD Fellowship *2024 – 2025*
- Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Booth School of Business *2023*
  Best TA nominated by Executive MBA cohort in London
- Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Booth School of Business *2023*
  Best TA nominated by Executive MBA cohort in Hong Kong
- Ph.D. Fellowship, Booth School of Business *2019 – 2024*

- Honors in Industrial Engineering and Operations Research, UC Berkeley *2019*
- URAP Summer Research Fellowship, Haas School of Business *2018*
- Silver Medal in Science Category, GENIUS Project Olympiad, *Syracuse, NY* *2013*
- Bronze Medal in Environmental Category, I-SWEEEP Project Olympiad, *Houston, TX* *2013*

PROJECTS

- **Amazon.com, Inc.**, Seattle, WA *2026*
  A Discrete-Time Batch Simulation Framework for Rapid Scenario Planning in Large-Scale Contact Centers
  Designed a scalable discrete-time simulation framework that models end-to-end customer journeys, from self-service to resolution in the contact center, as a Markov chain and handles millions of contacts per day. Because its runtime scales with the number of time steps rather than with contact volume, it runs scenarios that a discrete-event simulation cannot at this scale, and it has been adopted for peak-season planning.
- **United States Postal Service**, Oakland, CA *2019*
  Optimization of Package Zip Code Sorting Assignment at APBS Machines
  Optimized the package sorting process at the Oakland regional distribution center with a matching model formulated as a mixed integer linear program, significantly reducing the steps required by the workforce.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- **Referee:** *Queueing Systems*

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Programming skills:** `Python (TensorFlow, PyTorch)`, `C++`, `Julia`, `MATLAB`, `R`, `AMPL`.
- **Languages:** Turkish (native), English (fluent), German (intermediate), Spanish (beginner), Italian (beginner).
- **Hobbies/Interests:** Photography, Piano, Classical Music (Chopin, Tchaikovsky, Satie), Ukulele, Sailing, Windsurfing.
- **Nationality:** Turkish, U.S. Permanent Resident.

REFERENCES

Baris Ata
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